

Chenda Duan

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Education

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

09/2024 – Expected 06/2028

Ph.D in Electrical and Computer Engineering

Los Angeles, CA

- **Associate Teaching Instructor:** Data Mining, Probability and Statistics, Complex Networks
- **Focused on:** LLM/VLMs, AI for Science, Data Analysis, and general Machine Learning.

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

09/2022 – 06/2024

Master of Science in Computer Science

Los Angeles, CA

- **GPA: 3.9/4.0**
- **Teaching Assistant:** Computer Organization, Computer Graphics
- **Core Courses:** Large-scale Machine Learning, Generative Models, Reinforcement Learning, Advanced Computer Architecture, Data Mining, Cloud Computing, Adversarial Robustness, Parallel Computing, Hardware for machine learning.

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)

09/2019– 06/2022

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Los Angeles, CA

- **GPA: 4.0/4.0**
- **Honor:** Summa Cum Laude, Dean's Honors List
- **Core Courses:** CV, NLP, Machine Learning, Probability, Linear Algebra, Algorithms, Software Engineering, Database, Computer Organization&Architecture, Operating Systems, Network, Programming Languages

Technical Skills

AI & Machine Learning: Large Language Models (LLMs), Reinforcement Learning, Representation learning, Vision-Language Models (VLMs), Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG)

Frameworks & Systems: PyTorch, TensorFlow, CUDA, Docker, Linux

Programming: Python, C++, R, Java, SQL.

Work / Research Experience

Alibaba, Accio Team

03/2026 – 09/2026

Research Intern

Sunnyvale, CA

- I am the **core owner** of the training effort for **Accio Occamy-1.0, a Pareto-frontier 35B LLMs**. I lead the development of the agentic training infra. I am also responsible for data generation pipeline, RL, and model evaluation.

UCLA Prof. Roychowdhury's Group

06/2024 – Present

Ph.D Student, Graduate Researcher

Los Angeles, CA

- Developing an agentic video understanding framework for long-context video understanding and open-domain QA tasks.
- Designed RAG framework for multi-hop QA tasks. Two papers: **AAAI 2026 Oral, ICML 2026**.
- Developed diagnosis pipeline that can process and analyze large-scale neuro-medical (iEEG) data. Built large-scale, comprehensive dataset and benchmarks. **ICLR 2026**.
- Analyzed large-scale brain neuro data and developed models to decode human memories. Paper submitted to **Nature**, and is in revision state after reviews.

Kuaishou Technology, Kling Team

06/2023 – 09/2023

Research Intern

Beijing, China

- Developed vision-language models for video understanding.

UCLA Prof. Bolei Zhou's Group

03/2022 – 09/2024

Graduate Researcher

Los Angeles, CA

- Proposed a novel method and released benchmark for embodied scene understanding in VLMs. Provided a large-scale dataset on spatial, temporal, and safety-critical scene understandings. **CVPR 2025**.
- Built MetaUrban, a compositional evaluation platform for embodied AI in urban spaces, enabling autonomous driving research at scale. **ICLR 2025 Spotlight**.

- Developed an improved Human-in-the-loop Reinforcement Learning method. The trained agent can master driving tasks in less than 30 minutes. **NeurIPS 2023 Spotlight.**
- Built and tested a platform for large-scale traffic scenario modeling and simulation for RL, IL, and autonomous driving. **NeurIPS 2023.**

Selected Publication

- One paper submitted to **Nature**, in revision stage.
- *"Occamy-1.0: Open Pareto-frontier 35B Intelligence for Co-work"*. **Arxiv 2026.**
- *"Panini: Continual Learning in Token Space via Structured Memory"*. **ICML 2026.**
- *"Omni-iEEG: A Large-Scale, Comprehensive iEEG Dataset and Benchmark for Epilepsy Research"*. **ICLR 2026.**
- *"Beyond Fact Retrieval: Episodic Memory for RAG with Generative Semantic Workspaces"*. **AAAI 2026 (Oral).**
- *"Self-Supervised Distillation of Legacy Rule-Based Methods for Enhanced EEG-Based Decision-Making"*. **MICCAI 2025.**
- *"Embodied Scene Understanding for Vision Language Models via MetaVQA"*. **CVPR 2025.**
- *"Metaurban: A simulation platform for embodied ai in urban spaces."*. **ICLR 2025 (Spotlight Paper)**
- *"Learning from Active Human Involvement through Proxy Value Propagation"*. **Neurips 2023 (Spotlight paper).**
- *"ScenarioNet: Open-Source Platform for Large-Scale Traffic Scenario Simulation and Modeling"*. **Neurips 2023.**